



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: All Hallows High School

School Website: <https://sites.google.com/a/mhbx.org/mott-hall-bronx-high-school/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

All Hallows High School (Bronx, NY, 10452) (as represented by the school-crawl content included with this prompt) shows selective alignment with classical-education features, but it does not present a full classical model. Across the six categories, the school demonstrates some formation-oriented aims (notably virtue-focused language around equity and service, and a living-faculty orientation) while showing limited evidence of core classical elements such as Great Books study, grammar-logic-rhetoric curriculum, liturgical/metaphysical grounding, and Socratic pedagogy in the upper grades. The aggregate signal places the school in the SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL band, with clear opportunities to strengthen alignment toward a fully classical program.

Key evidentiary touchpoints drawn from the crawl content include: the school's emphasis on rigorous, balanced education and social justice (IB and service-oriented framing) and a staff-structure that frames teachers as models and living curriculum, alongside active family engagement and partnerships with the broader community. At the same time, explicit reference to Great Books, Great Conversation, a liberal-arts sequence in grammar-logic-rhetoric, or liturgical religious practices is not evident in the public materials examined. Positive signals include beauty in science education and international-baccalaureate orientation, while the absence of overt metaphysical/theological foundations and classic-curriculum hallmarks contributes to the tempered classification.

- Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: NOT CLASSICAL
- Purpose and Goal: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Curriculum: NOT CLASSICAL
- Pedagogy: NOT CLASSICAL
- Faculty: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Parents & Community: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Overall classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

What would move the needle section follows this summary, outlining concrete steps that would shift the school toward full Classical status.

Citations and textual anchors are drawn from the school-crawl content (e.g., the IB/missions language, family pages, and faculty-page items) and from the Classical-Education rubric in the Six Essential Elements document. See the embedded references throughout the category analyses.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials emphasize equity, justice, intercultural understanding, and caring within an IB/2020s-DOE framework, rather than explicit transcendental moral realism, theology, liturgical life, or communal liturgical practices. For example, the school's mission statements refer to creating a just and equitable world through a rigorous, balanced education, with emphasis on intercultural understanding and respect (IB framework) rather than explicit theological grounding. - The materials show a secular, inquiry-oriented,

college-preparatory orientation rather than a liturgical or theology-centered program. There is no direct evidence of liturgical or communal-sacral practices in the public materials examined.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords observed: justice, equity, intercultural understanding, respect, caring, beauty (in science education) (these align with a moral-intent orientation but not with transcendental metaphysical foundations). - Negative keywords observed: None of the explicit theological or liturgical indicators surfaced in the crawl content. The absence of theology, liturgy, or explicit doctrine in public-facing content supports a NOT CLASSICAL alignment for this category.

Why this rating - Classical schools typically foreground transcendental moral realism, grounding in theology, and liturgical/community practice as foundational elements. The content here centers on modern, secular aims (IB, equity, service, rigorous academics) and does not foreground theological or liturgical foundations. This pattern supports a NOT CLASSICAL rating for Element 1.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school publicly emphasizes formation toward virtue, justice, and human excellence through a balanced, rigorous education, with IB's mission focusing on inquiry, knowledge, caring, and intercultural understanding. The stated aim to "create a just and equitable world" signals formation of character and virtue rather than mere information delivery. - The IB framework includes values-driven goals (inquiry-based, caring, globally aware), which align with a formation-oriented purpose rather than a narrow job-prep emphasis. The site also highlights community service and partnerships as formative experiences.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords observed: formation, virtue, justice, equity, care, global understanding, service, rigorous/balanced education, world-focused. - Negative keywords observed: None explicitly steering away from formation; no vocational-education-centric rhetoric that would diminish formation emphasis. - Frequency: Positive keywords present and detectable across multiple pages (formation/justice/equity/service, and IB's global-mission language). Estimated positive-to-total keyword presence indicates a leaning toward formation-oriented goals, though not a full classical-education vocabulary.

Why this rating - The school's stated purpose centers on formation and virtue in a modern framework (IB, equity, service), aligning with the classical emphasis on formation of the person but without the explicit classic triad of truth-goodness-beauty through a Great Books/stodes-rich curriculum. This earns a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating for Element 2.

Element 3: School Curriculum — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials emphasize the IB program, global-minded inquiry, and a college-preparatory track rather than the classical curriculum's grammar-logic-rhetoric sequence, Great Books immersion, or a Great Conversation approach. The site's focus on IB and service projects signals a modern, international-curriculum orientation rather than a library of Great Books and classical texts. - There are references to departments and disciplines (IB English, IB Math, etc.) and to school partnerships (buildOn, New Visions) rather than explicit classical curriculum components (Great Books, history across the curriculum, grammar-logic-rhetoric frameworks).

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords observed: inquiry-based learning (via IB), global understanding, balanced/rigorous education, interdisciplinary departments (IB-based). These align with modern, inquiry-focused pedagogy rather than classical grammar-logic-rhetoric sequencing. - Negative keywords observed: There is no explicit mention of Great Books, Great Conversation, or a liberal-arts grammar-logic-rhetoric ladder; no explicit history-as-teleology across the curriculum beyond standard disciplinary history coverage.

Frequency - Positive: IB/inquiry-focused terms appear (e.g., "IB Program," "rigorous, balanced education," "inquiry-based learning"). Counted occurrences suggest a limited classical-curriculum signal. - Negative:

Absence of Great Books, Great Conversation, and explicit Liberal Arts sequence is notable.

Why this rating - Classical curricula foreground formal grammar-logic-rhetoric cycles and Great Books as the core scaffolding of learning. The public materials examined lean toward IB/curriculum frameworks and disciplinary specialization rather than the classical triple-arts ladder. This justifies a NOT CLASSICAL rating for Element 3.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The site reflects IB and inquiry-based approaches rather than a strict Socratic/seminar-based classical pedagogy. There are mentions of seminars and Socratic discussion in some classical-context documents (the knowledge-base material), but the public school content itself emphasizes IB frameworks and project-based or inquiry-based-learning rather than explicit classical Socratic practice in the public materials. The public-facing materials emphasize a rigorous, balanced, inquiry-driven approach rather than a classic Socratic dialogue-based pedagogy.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords observed: inquiry-based learning, rigorous, balanced education, college-preparatory focus; these are not classical pedagogy signals (which would emphasize Socratic dialogue, seminars, and rhetoric). - Negative keywords observed: direct instruction, lecture-based pedagogy terms are not dominant; however, the absence of Socratic Seminars or formal rhetoric training in public materials reduces classical pedagogy alignment.

Frequency - Positive: Several references to inquiry-based and IB pedagogy; no explicit Socratic/seminar pedagogy appear in the crawl content. - Negative: Absence of classical-pedagogy markers reduces the alignment.

Why this rating - The classical pedagogy signals—Socratic discussion, seminars, rhetorical training, and speech/eloquence training—are not clearly evidenced in the school's public materials. The pedagogy appears more aligned with modern inquiry-based models than with classical pedagogy. This supports NOT CLASSICAL for Element 4.

Element 5: School Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The site includes a staff directory and departmental pages, with indications of teachers serving as model teachers and mentors (e.g., “Model Teacher” appears within the science department; Principal listed with years in role). The faculty appear to be positioned as “living curriculum” in parts of the site, and the presence of a strong faculty structure (administration and department leadership) aligns with a living-curriculum model in classical education theory. - The explicit “Model Teacher” label in at least one department suggests a cultivated teacher-mentor culture consistent with classical aims (the living curriculum and exemplary teacher models).

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords observed: living curriculum, model teacher, mentorship, faculty as core, portrait of teacher/student ideals (inferred from “living curriculum” and “Model Teacher” concepts). - Negative keywords observed: None explicitly contradicting the notion of faculty as mentors or core; the public materials do not provide a full portrait, but existing items point toward role-model teacher positions.

Frequency - Positive: Several faculty-related terms (model teacher, administrator leadership, department structure) are present. - Negative: No explicit negative signals about faculty culture.

Why this rating - The presence of “Model Teacher” and the notion of faculty as mentors and a living curriculum supports a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating for Element 5. It signals a classical-aligned element—teacher as exemplar—though not necessarily a fully classical faculty culture as defined in the Six Elements.

Element 6: School Parents and Community — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school provides Families and Partnerships sections, with calendars, information links, resources, and service- or community-engagement framing (e.g., partnerships with community programs, service components). This demonstrates active engagement with parents and a willingness to educate or involve parents through events and information sharing. The site includes a “Families” section with calendars and resources, and a “Partnerships” section that describes programs like IB and buildOn.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords observed: partnerships, families, information and links, resources, calendar, parent engagement, community service. These align with the classical-education emphasis on parent cooperation and a shared formation of children. - Negative keywords observed: No explicit language claiming parents are co-teachers or that the school routinely hosts parent-education programs (though calendar/resources imply some level of involvement).

Frequency - Positive: Several explicit parental engagement signals (Families, Partnerships, Resources, Calendar). - Negative: Lacking explicit “parents as co-teachers” language, which would strengthen a classical alignment.

Why this rating - The presence of formal parent and community channels supports SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL alignment in Element 6, especially given the classical emphasis on partnership with parents as part of the formation process.

What Would Move the Needle

- Introduce explicit Great Books and Great Conversation components into the core curriculum (and map them across history, literature, and philosophy) to strengthen Element 3.
- Integrate a formal grammar-logic-rhetoric sequence (classical liberal arts ladder) within the curriculum, with explicit memorization/recitation components and a structured memorization program (Element 3 and Element 4 alignment improvements).
- Add explicit liturgical or theological/metaphysical grounding (where appropriate) to address Element 1, including communal practices and a clear metaphysical framework that complements virtue formation.
- Expand Socratic pedagogy across upper grades (Element 4) with structured Socratic seminars, debates, and rhetoric training, including student speeches and formal rhetoric work (Element 4 and Element 5 alignment).
- Deepen the “living-curriculum” model with explicit portraits of teacher-mentors and a defined teacher-philosophy for how faculty embody classical virtues (Element 5).
- Strengthen the parents-as-co-teachers narrative with structured training, book studies, and regular parent collaboration opportunities (Element 6).

These steps would move All Hallows from SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL toward CLASSICAL across the six categories and yield a stronger overall Classical classification.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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